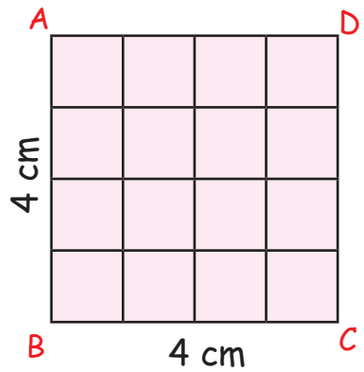


The points on opposite sides were joined as shown in the figure above. In the square ABCD we have created 4 rows of 4 squares each. The length of the sides of each square thus created is 1 cm.

Therefore, the area of each square is 1 sq.cm, which is the unit square.

Look at the square given above. The side of the square is 4 cm and we have 16 squares of 1cm each within this square.

The number of unit squares formed are the same as the product of two sides of the square.

Since the length of each side of the square is 4 cm the area of the square = 4 x 4 = 16 sq.cm.

Therefore, the area of a square = length of a side x length of a side

It is not necessary to divide a square or rectangle into small squares every time when you calculate their area. The advantage of a formula is that you can calculate the area simply by substituting the appropriate values.

Example 1.5

What is the area of a rectangle of length 10 cm and breadth 8 cm?

Solution

Area of a rectangle = length x breadth

= 10 x 8

= 80

Therefore, the area of the rectangle is 80 sq.cm.

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